

Daily Scholar Papers Report — 2026-08-02

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Window covered: 2026-08-01 → 2026-08-02 (Google Scholar alerts + user-curated self-emails, last 24 h)

Executive Summary

No new candidates arrived in today's 24-hour window. Both intake channels — Google Scholar alerts and the user-curated self-email queue — returned zero threads at run time. Each was re-queried in an absolute-date form, and the self-email channel was additionally re-queried without its `subject:` filter, to confirm the gap is real rather than an artefact of Gmail's rolling window or of an over-narrow query. A deliberately loose three-day sweep surfaced only a weekly preprint newsletter, which is promotional rather than a reading candidate and is out of scope for the digest. No papers were screened at Stage-1 and none were deep-read.

Because an empty result is only informative if the query path is known to work, the Scholar channel was also probed at a wider radius as a positive control: a seven-day query returned seven threads, all dated 2026-07-26 or 2026-07-27. The connector is therefore live and correctly authorised, and today's zero yield reflects the absence of new mail rather than a broken query path.

One deviation from the archive's usual continuity is worth recording: no digest was produced for 2026-07-31 or 2026-08-01, so the scheduled runs on those two days did not execute. The absolute-date cross-checks above were deliberately widened to span that gap, and both channels return zero across the whole span. Nothing arrived during the outage and was then rolled past by the rolling-window policy, so effective coverage remains continuous from 2026-07-26 to today despite the two-day hole in the report files. The most recent Scholar batch on file still dates to 2026-07-27 and was triaged in full by an earlier run.

Outstanding: 0 · **Keep:** 0 · **Borderline High-Priority:** 0

Highlighted Papers

No papers to list for this window.

Cross-Paper Synthesis

Not applicable — empty window.

Writing & Rationale Insights

Not applicable to today's intake, but two aspects of the run belong in the archive.

The first is methodological, and it is the same discipline this digest has applied on every quiet day: a negative result deserves the same evidentiary standard as a positive one. An empty report is only trustworthy if the emptiness has been probed from more than one direction, which is why each channel was checked against a second and, where the query carried filters that could themselves be the cause, a third formulation. Today adds a refinement worth keeping — the positive control. Re-querying the same channel at a wider radius and confirming that it *does* return results establishes that the query path works, which converts “we found nothing” into the considerably stronger “there is nothing to find.” Absence of evidence and evidence of absence are different claims, and only the second is worth writing down.

The second concerns the report series as a time series rather than as a set of daily documents. Two scheduled runs did not fire, and the resulting hole in the archive is not self-announcing: a missing file looks identical to a day nobody asked about. What makes the gap benign here is not that the runs were recovered but that the recovery query was widened to cover the un-run days, so the claim of continuous coverage rests on evidence rather than on assumption. For any pipeline that maintains a rolling window over a mailbox, that is the failure mode to design against — an outage silently converts “not yet processed” into “permanently skipped,” because the window moves on regardless of whether anyone was watching. Reconciling against absolute dates rather than relative ones after a missed run costs one extra query and is the difference between a verified archive and a merely plausible one.

On cadence: counting the two verified-empty but unreported days, the Scholar channel has now delivered nothing for six consecutive days. That is materially longer than the one-to-three-day cluster gaps seen through mid-July. A single quiet window says little about the field, but a run of this length starts to say something about the subscription rather than the literature, and is worth a direct check if the silence continues.